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Initial discussions with the Department of Defense to rent actual F-22s got under way, but what with a war going on, DoD concerns about how close the planes would get to each other, and the huge expense of rental costs, those discussions ultimately went nowhere. But the resourceful Nelson did not give up on his mandate to find a way to shoot the scene with practical elements.

NELSON: "We rented a pair of vintage Korean War planes (a Mig and an F-85) and then we hired movie pilots who could stunt fly ten feet from each other. We pre-vised the sequence, and then shot from a Lear jet as close as we possibly could to the jets. Later, we replaced the planes with CG visuals of F-22s and added Iron Man."